Supplementary methods: spatial refitting and alignment

This supplement accompanies *Matched-label analysis identifies spatial refitting and alignment gains in motor-imagery EEG*. It defines the matched-label component analysis, original comparison and subsequent component experiments. The accompanying data package contains the participant tables, prediction identities and reproduction scripts.

Abbreviations: AR, autoregressive; BA, balanced accuracy; BCI, brain–computer interface; BN, batch normalization; CSP, common spatial patterns; EA, Euclidean alignment; EEG, electroencephalography; KL, Kullback–Leibler divergence; LDA, linear discriminant analysis; MI, motor imagery; SOS, second-order sections; SPD, symmetric positive-definite.

S 1. Kumar analysis layers and statistical units

Layer	Participants	Scientific role	Model/seed information	Selection status
Original comparison	18, partitioned as six development and 12 primary	Full CSP/LDA minus frozen was the primary contrast; full minus LDA-only was secondary	Original EEGNet reference: three seeds and 54 source models	Original pipeline and endpoint hierarchy frozen before primary performance calculation; prior exploratory exposure retained in the record
V2 extension	The same six development participants	Candidate covariance mixture versus EA-CSP; support-budget and neural diagnostics	18 separately versioned individual sources	Later design informed by earlier results
V3 extension	The same six development participants	Predefined candidate comparisons and component mechanisms	Read-only reuse of 18 V2 sources; three new pooled sources; all fixed seeds	Task matrix and comparison roles frozen before execution
Mechanism simulation	No human participants	Known-mechanism estimator stress tests	384 scenarios × 50 paired draws × nine methods	Synthetic, with software_validation_only=true; separate from real EEG evidence

Participant was the independent unit for real-EEG intervals. Seeds were averaged within session and sessions within participant. V2/V3 used the same already-exposed development participants; their intervals are pointwise exploratory summaries. Pooled teachers are shared across participant evaluations, so their bootstrap uncertainty is conditional on the fitted teachers. Model, seed and repeated-prediction counts describe the nested experiments. The external cohort and its fixed endpoints are described in Section S12.

S 2. Exact data access and endpoint definition

The original source-training set comprised session 0/runs 0–1, validation run 2, and source query run 3. The first whole run of each later session supplied support, with subsequent whole runs reserved for query. The chronological support prefixes were capped at 4/8/12/16/20 complete trials in V2/V3; the last cap retained 19 if only 19 complete support windows were available. A prefix containing one class was preserved. Future labels were never used to balance it, choose a policy, select a model or replace a missing class.

The two conventional updates pooled the same 40 source-training trials with the same 19/20 current-support trials. The frozen comparator used source training alone. Neural fine-tuning in V3 optimized current support only, starting from the specified source checkpoint. The functional constraint additionally evaluated the participant's 40 source-training examples as fixed prediction anchors. Source validation selected source epochs; it did not select target adaptation epochs. The pooled source regime used the six participants' source training/validation sets, not their query data.

Methods evaluated on the same query set used identical ordered trial IDs and true labels. EA-CSP predictions imported from V2 were matched by these arrays and their checksums because query-hash conventions differed between versions.

BA required both true classes. Participant target endpoints required all five sessions and all scheduled neural seeds. Undefined groups retained an explicit missing status. Source-query metrics were reported separately. The original trial exclusions and five-second window definition were retained.

Cue-window interpretation

Seven thousand one hundred fifty-six complete sample windows were retained from 7,200 exported events; 44 crossed recording boundaries. The event-code documentation and MOABB interval establish the released cue-anchored convention. Reconstructing phase-pure motor imagery for each window would additionally require original marker arrays, task-end/feedback boundaries and the precise derivative-conversion lineage. Each partial event denotes an incomplete recorded window; interpreting its task phase requires those original boundaries.

S 3. Original prediction-transition and sensitivity definitions

For binary labels c∈{0, 1}, define C_c as the proportion of true-class-c trials that change from incorrect under A to correct under B, and E_c for the reverse transition. Then

$$\Delta BA = 1/2\,(C_0 + C_1) - 1/2\,(E_0 + E_1).$$

The two contributions were averaged over five sessions within each participant before cohort inference. They exactly reconstruct the saved BA difference. The 73.7 % spatial-component share is the descriptive ratio of cohort-average full-minus-LDA-only to full-minus-frozen. It decomposes the observed pipeline contrasts.

Original primary-cohort mean full-minus-LDA-only was 5.47 pp, with corrected-error and introduced-error contributions 16.04 pp and 10.57 pp. Left/right recall changes were 6.16 pp and 4.78 pp, with both individual intervals including zero. The same component contrast was positive in 10/12 participant averages and all five session means; participant-deletion means ranged 4.39–6.28 pp. Session profiles and participant-deletion summaries locate the component gain within the longitudinal data.

The pre-existing amplitude flag was 250 µV maximum raw channel peak-to-peak. It flagged 1,512/7,156 complete windows. Saved-prediction/QC matching used trial identity, role, true label and inclusion status. The unflagged target endpoint required both classes in every session; only ten original primary participants met that criterion. Their unflagged full-minus-frozen gain was 5.96 pp [0.99, 11.24] and component gain 3.82 pp [1.11, 6.72]. Their corresponding full-query gains were 6.50 pp and 4.53 pp. Source and support data were retained during this amplitude-conditional query restriction; the flag identifies a signal-amplitude property rather than a complete artifact assessment.

The original post-hoc exact sign-flip tests enumerated all 2^n sign assignments of the participant differences, retaining their magnitudes. The statistic was the absolute mean paired difference, with an inclusive boundary tolerance of 10^{-12} in BA units. The four-test family comprised full-minus-frozen, full-minus-LDA-only and LDA-only-minus-frozen in the 12-person primary cohort, and full-minus-frozen in the ten-person eligible unflagged subset. Unadjusted p values were 0.01953125, 0.01025390625, 0.26123046875 and 0.076171875; Holm-adjusted values were 0.05859375, 0.041015625, 0.26123046875 and 0.15234375, respectively. These tests use a sign-symmetric null conditional on the observed magnitudes. The original percentile-bootstrap intervals are pointwise and unadjusted for this family.

S 4. Geometric estimator

Source-fixed feature space

Each trial covariance was trace-normalized and regularized using shrinkage 0.1. Let R_s be the source-training-only reference covariance and

$$z = \mathrm{vech}_{\sqrt{2}}\{\log\left(R_s^{-1/2} C R_s^{-1/2}\right)\}.$$

The symmetric-vector operator multiplies off-diagonal elements by √2 to preserve the Frobenius inner product. With 22 channels, p=253. The reference remains fixed for every current-session budget and all queries. Trace normalization and identity shrinkage do not confer strict invariance to arbitrary affine sensor transformations.

For a domain d, define class means μ_{d0}, μ_{d1} and

$$m_d = (\mu_{d0} + \mu_{d1})/2, \qquad h_d = (\mu_{d1} - \mu_{d0})/2, \qquad \theta_d = [m_d; h_d].$$

Class feature covariance estimates B_dc use fixed 0.1 shrinkage. With U_dc=B_dc/n_dc, the estimated mean-observation covariance is

$$V_d = \frac{1}{4}\begin{bmatrix} U_{d0} + U_{d1} & U_{d1} - U_{d0} \\ U_{d1} - U_{d0} & U_{d0} + U_{d1} \end{bmatrix}.$$

Separate shift-variation scales are

$$\tau_j^2 = \max\{\left(\| \theta_{tj} - \theta_{sj} \|^2 - \mathrm{tr}\left(V_{s,jj} + V_{t,jj}\right)\right)/p, 0\}, \quad j \in \{m, h\}.$$

Let T=diag(τ_m²I,τ_h²I), M=V_s+T. With both classes observed,

$$\hat{\theta} = \theta_s + M(M + V_t)^{-1}(\theta_t - \theta_s), \qquad P = M - M(M + V_t)^{-1}M.$$

The implementation uses a masked linear-Gaussian update and the Joseph form for P. For a single observed class, the mask retains only that class's observations, unidentifiable shift variation is set to zero, and the unobserved class retains its source mean. A class represented by one support trial uses the fixed source class covariance as its variance proxy. The numerical floor is 10^{-8}.

Conditional result and prediction

Under the specified Gaussian observation/prior model with known fixed noise matrices, completing the square gives the posterior above. For any estimate a, posterior expected squared error is tr(P)+‖a−θ‖²; the posterior mean minimizes that conditional risk. Plug-in covariance estimation, uncertainty in R_s, and uncertainty in source within-class covariance are outside that statement. The implementation propagates conditional class-mean uncertainty, not all representation uncertainty.

For class 0/1, let A_c=[I,−I] or [I, I]. The full candidate scores a Gaussian with mean A_cθ̂ and covariance Q_c=W+A_cPA_c^T, using equal class priors and fixed source within-class covariance W. Point prediction uses the same θ̂ and W without P. B/n assumes independent observations; serial-correlation simulations explicitly test violation of that approximation. The risk identity concerns class-mean squared error under the stated Gaussian model; classification accuracy and target BA are evaluated empirically.

Complete arm definitions

Saved method ID	Defining difference
source_tangent_frozen	Source-fixed means and within-class covariance
tangent_pooled	Ordinary source/support pooled means; fixed source within-class covariance

Saved method ID	Defining difference
tangent_refit	Ordinary source/support refitting of means and within-class covariance
eb_point	Candidate posterior means; prediction uses fixed W without P
eb_predictive	Full candidate posterior means and predictive covariance
eb_isotropic	Isotropic mean-noise replacement, retaining predictive covariance
eb_coupled	One common shift scale instead of separate m/h scales
eb_no_source_noise	Same estimated T, with source mean-noise covariance removed
eb_no_shift	T=0, retaining finite-sample mean updating

The candidate-minus-tangent_refit cap 20 comparison retains its prespecified primary role. Candidate-minus-saved-V2-EA-CSP is the strong reference. Other budgets and ablations provide the full component profiles.

S 5. Neural update modes and optimization

The compact HPC network uses temporal_filters 8, depth_multiplier 2, kernel_length 64, source Dropout 0.25, BN epsilon 0.001 and momentum 0.01. The individual regime reuses 18 V2 checkpoint identities; the pooled regime uses three new shared source checkpoints trained on 240 source-training/120 source-validation examples. These six participants are the same people in both conditions.

All optimizer adaptations use 20 epochs, batch 16, AdamW, learning rate 10^{-4}, weight decay 10^{-4}, cosine scheduling and no AMP. A separate saved sampler controls support order. The methods reset to their own declared teacher before adapting each current-session/budget; they do not accumulate future support. Source normalization is reused rather than refitted from query.

Policy (readable name)	Optimized parameters	Adaptation BN mode	Dropout during adaptation
Frozen	None	Source statistics	Off
Head only, fixed BN	Classifier head	Source statistics	Off
Full, fixed BN	All	Source statistics	Off
Full, adaptive BN	All	Current minibatch statistics; running-state updates	Off
Full, adaptive BN + Dropout	All	Current minibatch statistics; running-state updates	On
BN affine, fixed statistics	BN affine scale/bias only	Source statistics	Off
BN statistics only	No optimizer; one support batch	Running-state update	Off
Full, KL constrained	All, subject to source KL constraint	Source statistics	Off

Canonical policy IDs are retained in the complete machine-readable tables: frozen, head_fixed, full_fixed, full_adaptive_bn, full_adaptive_bn_dropout, bn_affine_fixed, bn_stats_only and trust_fixed, in the row order above.

Fixed/adaptive BN changes normalization during gradient computation and the resulting running state; weight trajectories can consequently differ. Within each budget, initialization, support order, Dropout and optimizer exposure are held fixed. Across budgets, examples and minibatch structure change together: batch 16 gives one batch per epoch for caps≤16 and two for 19/20. With three BN modules, 20 epochs correspond to 60 or 120 total batch-counter increments. Thus the within-budget comparison identifies the BN-mode effect, while the between-budget profiles combine label quantity, class composition and update schedule.

The functional policy evaluates teacher-to-candidate mean KL on 40 source-training anchors and enforces δ=0.01 in the core experiment, with separate full runs at 0.001 and 0.1. Up to 12 halvings are

attempted for a proposed optimizer step. Rejected proposals restore parameters and Adam state and are counted separately from accepted optimizer updates. These steps form the constrained optimizer's proposal procedure. Pinsker and Jensen give mean anchor total variation $\leq\sqrt{(\delta/2)}$. The bound concerns prediction probabilities on the source anchors; target BA is an empirical endpoint.

S 6. Complete reporting, intervals and influence

Machine-readable tables retain every method, budget, participant, session and seed, together with the predefined contrast roles. Original intervals use 10,000 participant resamples with seed 42; extension intervals use the same number with seed 20261023. Complete method and budget profiles accompany the selected component interpretations.

The cap 20 BN-mode participant-deletion mean ranges were +1.07 to +1.90 pp for individual sources and +1.34 to +2.29 pp for pooled sources. These summaries assess participant influence on the same six-person result.

Collapse means a model/session predicts one class on its query set even when both true classes exist. Cap 20 fixed-BN/adaptive-BN collapse counts were 8/16 for individual sources and 0/18 for pooled sources, each out of 90 nested seed/session cells. All predictions contributed to BA; participant averages define the independent endpoint.

S 7. Complete saved synthetic grid

The fixed factorial grid used $p\in\{16, 64\}$, source examples per class$\in\{10, 20,100\}$, support examples per class$\in\{1, 2, 5, 10\}$, shift type$\in\{$none, common, contrast, both$\}$, anisotropy$\in\{1, 20\}$, and stationary AR(1) correlation$\in\{0, 0.5\}$. Shift scale was 0.5, with 50 paired draws and 100 query examples per class. All nine methods received the same source/support/query draws within each replicate. The estimator used its fixed variance approximation across all generating correlations.

All 172,800 saved cells were retained with finite metrics and explicit synthetic/software-validation flags. Cross entropy uses the true-class probability with a numerical lower bound of 10^{-15} before taking the logarithm. Outcomes comprise BA, cross entropy, binary Brier score and two class-mean squared-error definitions. Full-grid averaging gives every frozen scenario equal weight. Paired Monte Carlo variation measures the finite draws under these fixed generating conditions, separately from the human-participant endpoint intervals.

The companion figure and saved scenario table display performance by shift, noise anisotropy, dimension, source size and serial correlation. Full-grid summaries accompany the factor-specific profiles. Probability-based EEG diagnostics use the saved probabilities; their numerical logarithmic-scoring floor is identified in the analysis record.

S 8. Calibration measurements and interpretation

Original source/support probes evaluated low-dimensional power and source-fitted representations, followed by supervised CSP4/LDA controls. The support-half analysis split each class chronologically and retained frozen source transforms. Among 30 sessions, 19 had positive signed source-score orientation in both halves, two were negative in both, and nine changed sign. These observations distinguish calibration-subset agreement from the intended class orientation, providing measurements for future support-driven policy tests.

The Kumar and V2/V3 endpoints are offline task-label decoding in the same longitudinal cohort. Cue/feedback contributions, zero-phase filtering and amplitude artifacts in fitting/query data affect their interpretation. Pooled-source and source-validation labels are explicit information-budget differences. The separate fixed-budget BNCI replication in Section S12 evaluates spatial update operations in another acquisition; independent neural validation remains a further step.

S 9. Saved-result provenance and computational scope

The V3 raw received archive is `paper2-results-83cbdfdcfa541b3ab3addfc3.tar.gz`, 40,194,093 bytes, SHA256 `e509c2591efa21fff4dd47236e613ed6b611ca10ad20bac3da37e66e34a9d170`. It comprises three verified GitHub parts at fixed commit `500831c086d9e1d1e8412cf8ebca5fb6a288db76`. Its 49,984 payload files plus manifest matched their lengths and checksums; 126 unique valid task-completion identities matched the frozen queue. The public packet contains no original EEG, optimizer tensors or model weights.

Runtime, scheduler and storage records are provided in the repository audit reports. Saved-prediction reconstruction supplies the numerical verification.

Kumar analyses reused saved predictions, metrics and histories with their original fitted models, seeds and support windows. The external comparison in Section S12 generated its own four-method predictions. Original submission packages and all experiment outcomes remain at their versioned paths. Reproduction scripts, table definitions, figure inputs and targeted verification are identified in the accompanying revision report.

S 10. Complete V3 cohort means across all frozen budgets

Values are BA percentages. Every row uses all six participants, all five target sessions and all declared seeds where applicable. `core`, `kl0p001` and `kl0p1` identify the separately frozen variants. The saved EA reference is included under the geometric scope after ordered query-identity alignment.

Family / source / variant	Method	Cap 4	Cap 8	Cap 12	Cap 16	Cap 20
Geometry / own / core	EB coupled	57.82	60.33	61.63	66.10	61.35
Geometry / own / core	EB isotropic	62.37	62.72	65.14	66.31	64.57
Geometry / own / core	EB no shift	59.06	57.23	60.62	62.53	60.22
Geometry / own / core	EB no source noise	57.83	59.95	63.01	65.27	61.71
Geometry / own / core	EB point	58.67	60.84	63.84	67.24	66.52
Geometry / own / core	EB predictive	59.11	61.48	63.92	66.63	64.68
Geometry / own / core	Saved V2 EA-CSP	66.79	67.48	67.71	70.86	70.37
Geometry / own / core	Frozen tangent	60.36	60.36	60.36	60.36	60.36
Geometry / own / core	Pooled means	59.46	59.73	61.61	64.46	64.08
Geometry / own / core	Tangent refit	63.50	62.90	66.19	66.97	67.01
Neural / pooled / core	BN affine, fixed statistics	55.23	55.02	55.39	55.49	55.46
Neural / pooled / core	BN statistics only	55.22	55.24	55.32	55.29	54.95
Neural / pooled / core	Frozen	55.26	55.26	55.26	55.26	55.26
Neural / pooled / core	Full, adaptive BN	55.27	55.61	55.41	55.34	54.31
Neural / pooled / core	Full, adaptive BN + Dropout	55.28	55.61	55.39	55.41	54.59
Neural / pooled / core	Full, fixed BN	56.02	55.61	55.90	56.66	56.22
Neural / pooled / core	Head only, fixed BN	55.48	55.41	55.57	55.74	55.54
Neural / pooled / core	Full, KL constrained	56.02	55.61	55.87	56.66	56.25
Neural / pooled / KL 0.001	Full, KL constrained	55.77	55.25	55.64	56.45	56.03
Neural / pooled / KL 0.1	Full, KL constrained	56.02	55.61	55.90	56.66	56.22
Neural / individual / core	BN affine, fixed statistics	56.73	56.73	56.76	57.11	57.04
Neural / individual / core	BN statistics only	56.73	56.73	56.71	56.73	55.59
Neural / individual / core	Frozen	56.74	56.74	56.74	56.74	56.74
Neural / individual / core	Full, adaptive BN	57.08	57.11	57.26	57.54	56.01
Neural / individual / core	Full, adaptive BN + Dropout	57.25	57.18	57.16	57.43	55.86

Family / source / variant	Method	Cap 4	Cap 8	Cap 12	Cap 16	Cap 20
Neural / individual / core	Full, fixed BN	56.90	56.77	56.80	57.50	57.51
Neural / individual / core	Head only, fixed BN	56.39	56.45	56.84	56.88	56.81
Neural / individual / core	Full, KL constrained	56.91	56.83	56.87	57.50	57.50
Neural / individual / KL 0.001	Full, KL constrained	56.64	56.68	56.83	57.32	57.29
Neural / individual / KL 0.1	Full, KL constrained	56.90	56.77	56.80	57.50	57.51

All paired participant differences, pointwise intervals, negative-participant counts and reference-role labels are retained in the companion comparison table. The full primary geometric and neural outcomes appear in the main text; this table supplies the complete budget context.

S 11. Complete-grid synthetic method summary

These means give every frozen scenario and paired draw equal weight. Probability scoring uses the saved simulation definitions; these numerical scales apply to the synthetic generator.

Method	BA (%)	Cross entropy	Binary Brier	Mean squared feature error
source_tangent_frozen	74.31	2.9701	0.2276	0.10815
tangent_pooled	75.72	2.5729	0.2134	0.08115
tangent_refit	76.19	2.2408	0.2064	0.08115
eb_point	70.40	3.9747	0.2688	0.26669
eb_predictive	70.36	3.6337	0.2669	0.26669
eb_isotropic	73.29	2.0276	0.2304	0.16210
eb_coupled	70.58	3.5845	0.2646	0.25179
eb_no_source_noise	70.28	3.7042	0.2681	0.25980
eb_no_shift	74.87	2.5946	0.2210	0.13010

The full candidate minus tangent refitting was −5.8255 BA points. Of 384 scenario means, eight favored the candidate and 376 favored refitting. Candidate feature-mean squared error was larger than refitting in every scenario mean. Posterior-predictive versus point candidate prediction changed mean cross entropy by −0.34094, Brier by −0.00191 and BA by −0.0398 percentage points. The contrasts separate probability scoring from classification and mean estimation.

S 12. External component comparison with a fixed calibration budget

Dataset, events and information access

BNCI2014-001/BCI Competition IV 2a contains nine participants, each recorded on two different days. The reviewed original publication and six-page protocol describe six MI runs/session, with 48 four-class trials per run. The released original MAT files have all class labels; only left/right labels 1/2 were mapped to 0/1. Their `classes` arrays were explicitly checked. The initial EOG calibration objects have no MI trial indices and were excluded from MI-run numbering.

The one-based MAT `trial` field marks trial start. Cue onset is 500 samples later at 250 Hz. Epochs contain samples `trial-1+500 : trial-1+1500`, or cue [0,4) seconds, following the source MI instruction. Processing retains the recorded reference and first 22 EEG channels, excludes EOG, converts microvolts to volts, and applies fourth-order Butterworth 8–30 Hz SOS zero-phase filtering within each continuous run. No query-dependent normalization is fitted.

T runs 1–4 provide 96 source examples (48/class); T run 5 is unused and T run 6 is retained as an unused 24-trial source-query partition. E run 1 supplies its first 20 hand trials as support; four remaining hand trials are excluded. E runs 2–6 supply 120 query examples (60/class), with 24 per run. Support

retains chronological class imbalance rather than selecting balanced labels. All 576 original four-class records per person retain sample boundaries, original artifact flags, identities and exclusion reasons.

LDA-only, Full CSP/LDA and EA-CSP use identical 116 source/support trials; Frozen uses 96 source labels and zero target labels. EA has separate source/support covariance references and never estimates a reference from query signals. Four-component CSP and covariance/LDA shrinkage 0.1 use the existing V2 NumPy implementation. This differs from the original Kumar MNE/Ledoit–Wolf model and 40-example source setting; the between-dataset result cannot isolate acquisition from implementation and source-budget differences.

Complete results

BA values are percentages. Differences are percentage points; participants, not four-method or run rows, are the independent units.

Participant	Frozen	LDA-only	Full CSP/LDA	EA-CSP	Full − LDA	EA − Full
1	87.50	85.00	84.17	90.00	-0.83	+5.83
2	49.17	49.17	54.17	56.67	+5.00	+2.50
3	88.33	90.00	90.00	95.00	+0.00	+5.00
4	73.33	71.67	65.00	72.50	-6.67	+7.50
5	49.17	49.17	53.33	59.17	+4.17	+5.83
6	58.33	59.17	59.17	65.83	+0.00	+6.67
7	50.83	57.50	58.33	74.17	+0.83	+15.83
8	93.33	94.17	94.17	95.00	+0.00	+0.83
9	85.00	89.17	88.33	89.17	-0.83	+0.83
Mean	70.56	71.67	71.85	77.50	**+0.19**	**+5.65**

Contrast	Role	Mean difference, pp	Pointwise 95 % CI, pp	Exact p	Secondary Holm p
Full − LDA-only	primary	+0.19	[-1.85, 2.13]	0.96875	—
Full − Frozen	secondary	+1.30	[-1.76, 3.98]	0.45312	0.68750
LDA-only − Frozen	secondary	+1.11	[-0.46, 2.96]	0.34375	0.68750
EA − Full	secondary	+5.65	[3.15, 8.70]	0.00391	0.01172

The fixed primary comparison is Full−LDA-only, specified before this run's predictions. The three secondary comparisons form a separate Holm family. Exact two-sided sign-flip tests retain observed difference magnitudes over 512 assignments and use the absolute paired mean, with 1e−12 BA boundary tolerance. Pointwise percentile bootstrap intervals use 10,000 paired participant draws, seed 20261027 and numeric participant order 1–9.

Full−LDA-only is positive/negative/zero in 3/3/3 people; its leave-one-out mean spans −0.42 to +1.04 pp. EA−Full is positive in 9/9, with individual differences +0.83 to +15.83 pp and leave-one-out means +4.38 to +6.25 pp. Across query runs 2–6, EA−Full cohort means are +10.19, +2.78, +6.02, +6.94 and +2.31 pp. Floating-point tie handling is documented in the independent numerical audit.

Original artifact flags and ethics sources

No artifact-marked trials were rejected. Across nine people, the original flags occurred in 87 source-fit, 17 support and 94 query trials. These retained flags are different from Kumar's amplitude rule. This experiment uses all original labeled hand trials in its assigned roles; the competition used an artifact-free-only scoring convention.

The inspected BNCI2a source paper and original protocol did not report a dataset-2a-specific ethics committee, approval number or consent form. The paper's Harborview IRB/informed-consent paragraph belongs to Dataset 4 (ECoG) and is not attributed to these participants. The secondary analysis uses public coded records under the national-law basis stated in the main text, without recontact or re-identification. Original MAT recordings retain CC BY-ND 4.0 terms; public derived tables and code do not relicense the source recordings.

Version, execution and reconstruction

The protocol, raw-file identities and implementation were fixed at commit `457e7bdaad96e84782b6fe968f88925a1200c4b3` before prediction generation. The external experiment used nine source fits and 27 updating fits; frozen models reused the corresponding source fit. All 18 original MAT files matched the versioned NEMAR byte lengths and SHA256 checksums, totaling 779,873,919 bytes. Execution used Python 3.11.16, NumPy 2.2.6 and SciPy 1.15.3, with one BLAS thread.

The external public result folder is `research_logs/paper2_external_validation_20261027/`: all 36 saved prediction JSONs, trial-role manifests, participant/run tables, exact tests and an independent JSON-only reconstruction are retained. This covers 1,080 distinct target trials, 4,320 method-specific prediction rows and 180 nested run endpoints. Participants define the independent sample. BNCI had historical use in the first-paper project; the present component comparison was fixed in the repository before prediction generation.

The public repository supplies all saved predictions, trial-role manifests and numerical reconstruction code. Original EEG retains its source-data license. Private storage records and original transfer receipts are documented in the repository audit report.

Run `scripts/replay_paper2_external_saved_predictions_20261027.py` to regenerate the aggregate from public prediction JSON files. The result-folder REPRODUCE.md supplies the exact command and dependencies. Raw-data execution and resumption use the fixed script and a separate private output directory.